

Build the Foundation

What am I building my marriage on, and what am I personally responsible to reinforce?

Print this alongside the module, or type into it — every box is a real form field.

The workbook records what you did. This sheet records what you learned.

1 · WATCH AND LISTEN

Take these one at a time. A note you write in your own words is worth more than a highlight you never reread.

The Marriage Course

Video overview of foundation themes.

Notes — and the timestamp you want to come back to

The Blueprint and the Stress Test

Foundation habits under pressure.

Notes — and the timestamp you want to come back to

Blind spots in the vineyard marriage course

Where vineyard metaphors and habits misfire.

Notes — and the timestamp you want to come back to

Why The Marriage Course fails some couples

Limits and safety inversions.

Notes — and the timestamp you want to come back to

2 • DECKS AND FIELD GRAPHICS

On this module: Marital Maintenance Playbook; Tending the Marital Vineyard; Marriage Connection Roadmap; Marriage Vineyard Field Guide.

What stood out — and what I would push back on

3 • READING NOTES

Each report is an optional study aid built from thematically related research. It reflects the source material, not ministry doctrine — read it against the module's caution.

Building Strong Foundations

The Marriage Course is a practical series designed to equip couples with tools to build healthy, lifelong relationships.

Executive briefing on foundation habits.

What I take from this

From We to Me: Navigating the Seasons of Connection

We often begin our journeys together with a universal longing for a deep, unshakable connection. Yet, beneath our wedding photos and shared dreams, a common fear often lingers: the worry that intimacy is a finite resource destined to fade.

Seasons-of-life framing.

What I take from this

The Vineyard Secret: Five Surprising Lessons

In the modern world, maintaining a deep, lasting connection with a partner can feel like an uphill battle against the relentless tides of busyness and digital noise.

Popular-article register — use as prompt, not proof.

What I take from this

10 questions

Answer from memory first, then mark yourself against the answer key on the last page. The score matters less than the last column: a question you missed shows you exactly which part of the module to reread.

1. In the context of the 'Vineyard Metaphor,' what does the process of 'Pruning' specifically entail for a married couple?

RIGHT

MISSED

2. Which of the following describes the 'Three Tips' provided to ensure a weekly date becomes a consistent reality?

RIGHT

MISSED

3. According to the relationship expert cited in the episode, what is identified as the 'key issue' that causes marriages to fall apart?

RIGHT

MISSED

4. The episode presents a fundamental principle regarding personal change within a marriage. Which of the following best reflects that teaching?

RIGHT

MISSED

5. In the 'Knowing Me, Knowing You' exercise, what is a common error couples make when trying to nurture one another?

RIGHT

MISSED

6. Critics of Episode 1 point out a significant 'blind spot' regarding the course's advice for struggling couples. What is this primary concern?

RIGHT

MISSED

7. What is the intended meaning of the 'Winter Love' fisherman anecdote shared in the episode?

RIGHT

MISSED

8. The course makes a controversial claim about the hierarchy of priorities within a family. What is it?

RIGHT

MISSED

9. Which specific communication tool was demonstrated by the couple from Beijing to resolve misunderstandings?

RIGHT

MISSED

10. True or False: The presenters state that if you have low scores on the 'Reviewing Your Connection' assessment, your marriage is likely beyond repair.

RIGHT

MISSED

Score out of 10

The one I missed that matters most — and what I am going back to reread

5 · FLASHCARD DRILL

This module's deck holds 75 cards. Run it until you can answer without help, then note what still slips.

Cards marked known

Cards I still need to review

Mark yourself here

Every answer carries the reason it is the answer. If you missed one, the reason is the part worth rereading — not the letter.

1. In the context of the 'Vineyard Metaphor,' what does the process of 'Pruning' specifically entail for a married couple?

Prioritizing the marriage by reducing competing commitments like work, hobbies, or even excessive focus on children.

Pruning is described as a positive activity that redirects a couple's energy toward the 'most fruitful branches' of the relationship by cutting back lesser demands.

2. Which of the following describes the 'Three Tips' provided to ensure a weekly date becomes a consistent reality?

Plan, Prioritize, and Protect

The course teaches that couples must schedule the time, treat it as the most important commitment of the week, and defend it from distractions like phones.

3. According to the relationship expert cited in the episode, what is identified as the 'key issue' that causes marriages to fall apart?

Emotional disconnection and the feeling of 'aloneness' within the relationship.

The session teaches that the core trauma of a failing marriage is the inability to reach one's partner, leading to a state of isolation.

4. The episode presents a fundamental principle regarding personal change within a marriage. Which of the following best reflects that teaching?

I can change myself, but I cannot change my partner.

This principle is used to redirect energy from trying to control or coerce a spouse toward managing one's own choices and behaviors.

5. In the 'Knowing Me, Knowing You' exercise, what is a common error couples make when trying to nurture one another?

Providing the form of care that they themselves would most like to receive.

The course notes that people often project their own needs onto their partner, resulting in 'filling the wrong glass' and causing frustration.

6. Critics of Episode 1 point out a significant 'blind spot' regarding the course's advice for struggling couples. What is this primary concern?

The framework assumes a baseline of mutual goodwill and safety that may not exist in cases of abuse or coercive control.

Several reviews highlight that advice like 'focus on your faults' or 'disclose vulnerabilities' can be dangerous if one partner is manipulative or violent.

7. What is the intended meaning of the 'Winter Love' fisherman anecdote shared in the episode?

True commitment involves fighting to keep love alive even when the romantic 'feeling' has temporarily faded.

The story emphasizes that those who persevere through 'winter' often find themselves more in love than they ever thought possible years later.

8. The course makes a controversial claim about the hierarchy of priorities within a family. What is it?

The marriage relationship should be prioritized over every other demand, including parenting.

The logic presented is that a child's security is deeply affected by the parents' marriage, so loving one's spouse is the best way to love one's child.

9. Which specific communication tool was demonstrated by the couple from Beijing to resolve misunderstandings?

Repeating the partner's words, validating their feelings, and asking what help is needed.

This process—reflective listening and inquiry—helped the husband move from a 'rational' problem-solving mode to an empathetic connecting mode.

10. True or False: The presenters state that if you have low scores on the 'Reviewing Your Connection' assessment, your marriage is likely beyond repair.

False

The hosts explicitly reassure couples that 'low scores... could change rapidly, even after this session' if they begin to apply the tools provided.

Before you close this module

Field action: Establish your weekly 20-minute marriage check-in

Finish line: The next check-in is on the calendar, the first check-in occurred, and you completed one small act of care based on what you heard — whether or not she participated.

Study is not the assignment. The finish line is.